edX creates promotional website for its open source platform 'Open edX'

Open online course provider edX has launched a new marketing-oriented website for its open source software Open edX, which powers its educational portal and is freely available on GitHub.

This website, *open.edx.org*, has been developed with an investment of US$ 30,000 under the direction of Berkey Baykal, a business manager on edX, reports *IBL News*.

On the home page, Open edX is described as software that's trusted and used by leading organisations, such as edX, MIT, Harvard, IBM, Microsoft, XuetangX and Global Knowledge, among others. Overall, there are over 20,000 courses built on Open edX software and over 40 million learners.

To clear the confusion between edX and Open edX, the home page also carries an explanation which reads, "edX is the online learning destination co-founded by Harvard and MIT. Open edX is the learner-centric, massively scalable learning platform behind it."

Originally envisioned as a MOOC platform, Open edX has evolved into one of the leading learning platforms catering to higher education, enterprises, and government organisations alike.

Sources at edX claim that Open edX is a single platform for all your learning needs, and has been built to showcase the latest in learning sciences and instructional design. The learning platform is driven by edX's community of developers, technology partners, research teams, and users.

Google open sources its fuzzing tool 'ClusterFuzz'

Google has announced that it is open sourcing ClusterFuzz -- a scalable fuzzing infrastructure that finds out security and stability issues in software.

Debuted in 2011, ClusterFuzz runs on over 25,000 cores. It was developed by Google as a cloud-based tool to uncover memory corruption bugs and the like in its Chrome browser.

Two years ago, Google began offering ClusterFuzz as a free service to open source projects through OSS-Fuzz. "ClusterFuzz provides end-to-end automation, from bug detection, to triage (accurate deduplication and bisection), to bug reporting, and finally to automatic closure of bug reports," a Google blog post states.

According to the tech giant, ClusterFuzz has found more than 16,000 bugs in Chrome and more than 11,000 bugs in over 160 open source projects.

ClusterFuzz is often able to detect bugs hours after they are introduced and verify the fix within a day, the Google blog post claims.

The release of ClusterFuzz as an open source technology will enable open source project developers to integrate fuzzing into their workflows.

Open Mainframe Project makes z/OS environment more cloud-like with Zowe

Zowe is the first-ever open source project based on z/OS. It consists of core technologies enabling modern interfaces for Web applications on z/OS.

The Open Mainframe Project (OMP) has announced that Zowe, an open source software framework for the mainframe that strengthens integration with modern enterprise applications, is now production-ready less than six months after launching.

Any enterprise or solutions developer can access the Zowe 1.0 source code or convenience build and incorporate it into their products or services with the agility and scalability of a cloud platform.

Hosted by The Linux Foundation, the Open Mainframe Project comprises business and academic leaders from within the mainframe community that collaborate to develop shared toolsets and resources.

OMP launched Zowe last August to serve as an integration platform for the next generation of tools for administration, management and development on z/OS mainframes.

Zowe 1.0 consists of core technologies enabling modern interfaces for Web applications on z/OS, a new command line interface and the expansion of the platform's REST API capabilities. This makes the z/OS environment more cloud-like, and aims to improve integration in hybrid cloud environments.

The Zowe framework provides interoperability while using the latest Web technologies among products and solutions from multiple vendors. It enables developers to use the familiar, industry-standard, open source tools to access mainframe resources and services.